

The Circular Campus

A high-level playbook for students and academic professionals navigating La Trobe's Environmental Sustainability Policy.

Gemini Notebook

Embedding sustainability into everything we build, research, and teach

The Mandate

Continually improve environmental management to reduce the university's footprint, prepare for the University City of the Future, and operate on a strict "Do no harm" philosophy.

The Scope

Applies to all staff, students, contractors, operations, programs, research, and across all campuses.

The Academic Integration

We are committed to developing and implementing research and teaching initiatives directly related to sustainability, partnering with community groups and local government.



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The operational ecosystem driving campus transformation

	Operational Ecosystem Matrix	Energy Management	Sustainable Transport	Waste Management
1	**Infrastructure & Operations (I&O)**	Manage facility data; enforce energy-efficient design standards for all buildings.	Build infrastructure for walking, cycling, and remote work.	Ensure contractors separate waste; educate commercial tenants.
2	**Information Services (IT)**	Procure low-energy ICT equipment and networks.	Maximize communication tech to replace physical travel.	Enforce EPEAT hardware standards; manage authorized e-waste disposal.
3	**Strategic Sourcing**	Procure low-energy products based on total lifecycle emissions.	Transition to zero-emission vehicle fleet; offset university travel.	Drive product stewardship and circular material flows in contracts.
4	**Sustainability Project Steering Group (SPSG)**	Achieve carbon neutrality across all campuses; monitor University-Wide Sustainability Plan.		

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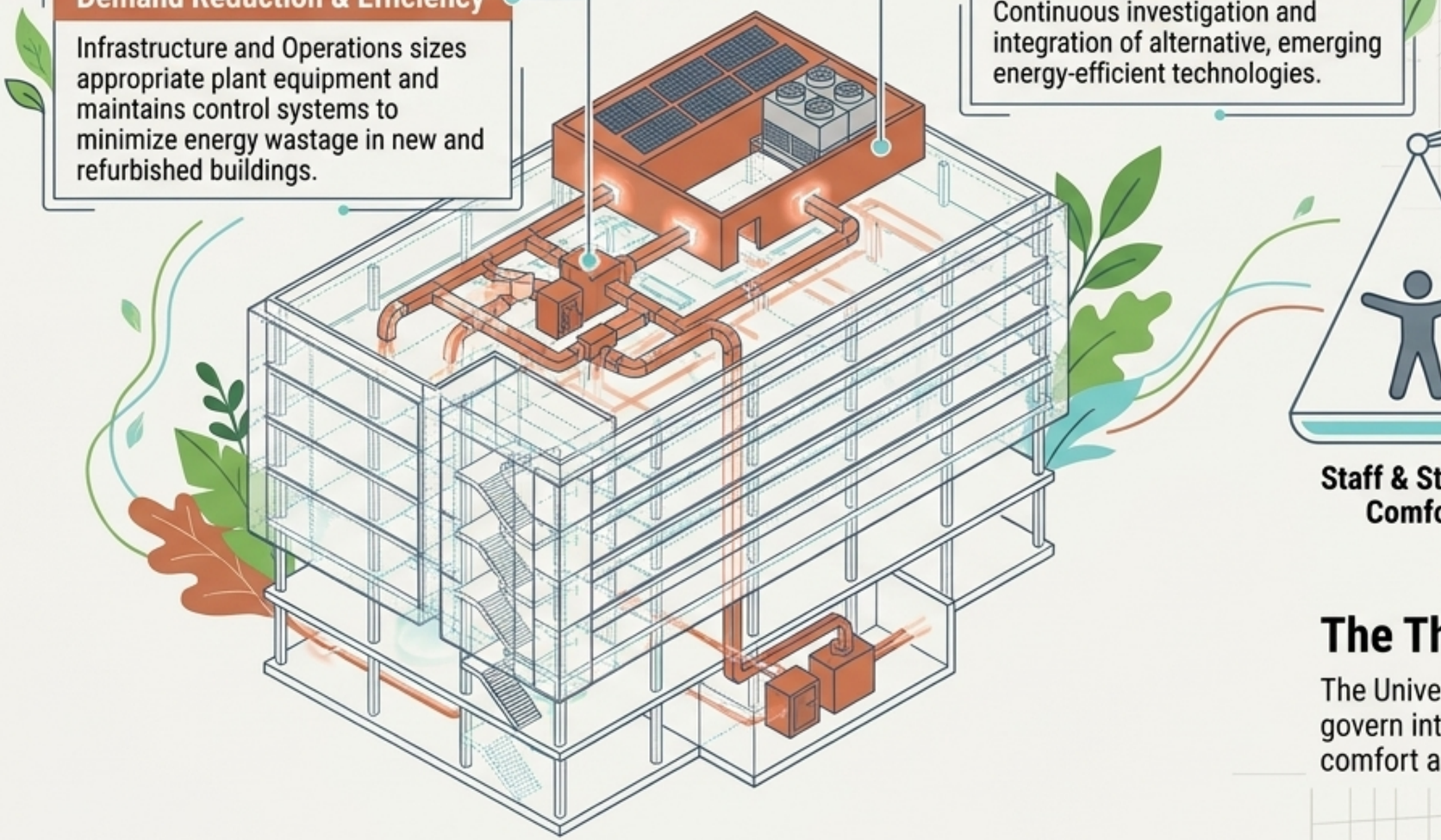
Optimizing the built environment for energy reduction

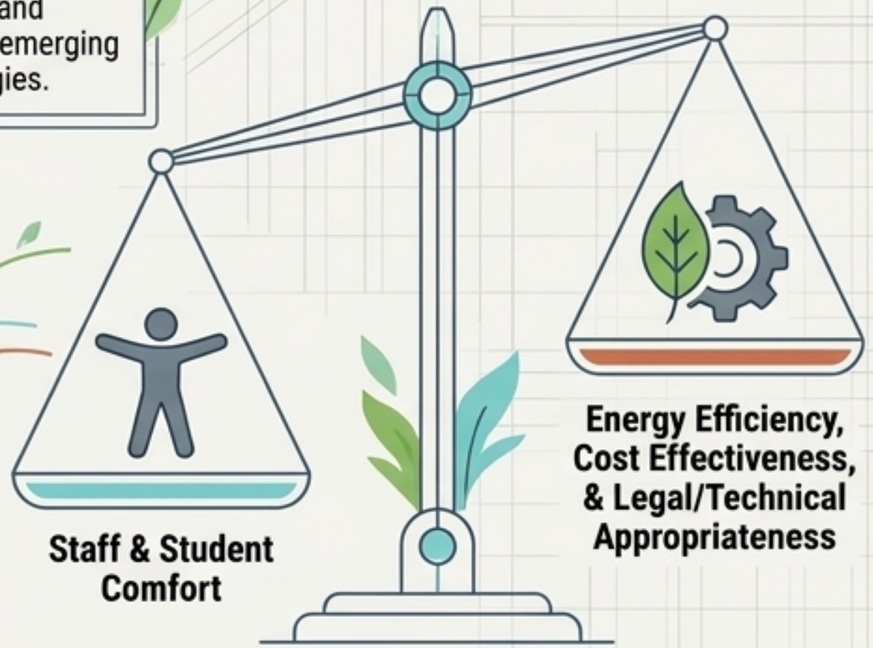
Demand Reduction & Efficiency

Infrastructure and Operations sizes appropriate plant equipment and maintains control systems to minimize energy wastage in new and refurbished buildings.

Alternative Technologies

Continuous investigation and integration of alternative, emerging energy-efficient technologies.





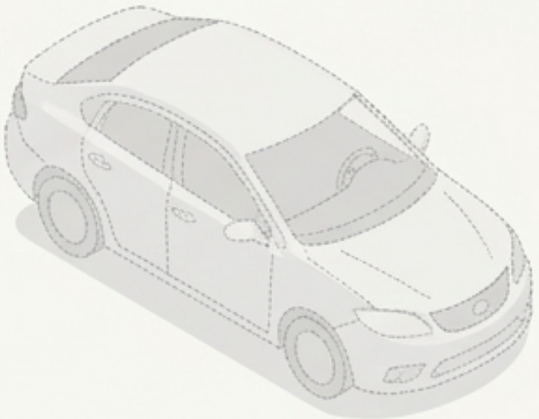
The Thermal Comfort Balance

The University's Workplace Thermal Comfort Guidelines govern internal temperatures, visually balancing human comfort against strict energy reduction mandates.

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Shifting the balance from physical travel to active and digital alternatives

Phase Out





Active Transport

I&O is tasked with planning and maintaining physical infrastructure that actively promotes walking and cycling, specifically to reduce single-occupancy car use.

Digital Alternatives

Information Services maximizes communication technology to seamlessly replace physical travel and support remote work.

University Fleet & Sourcing

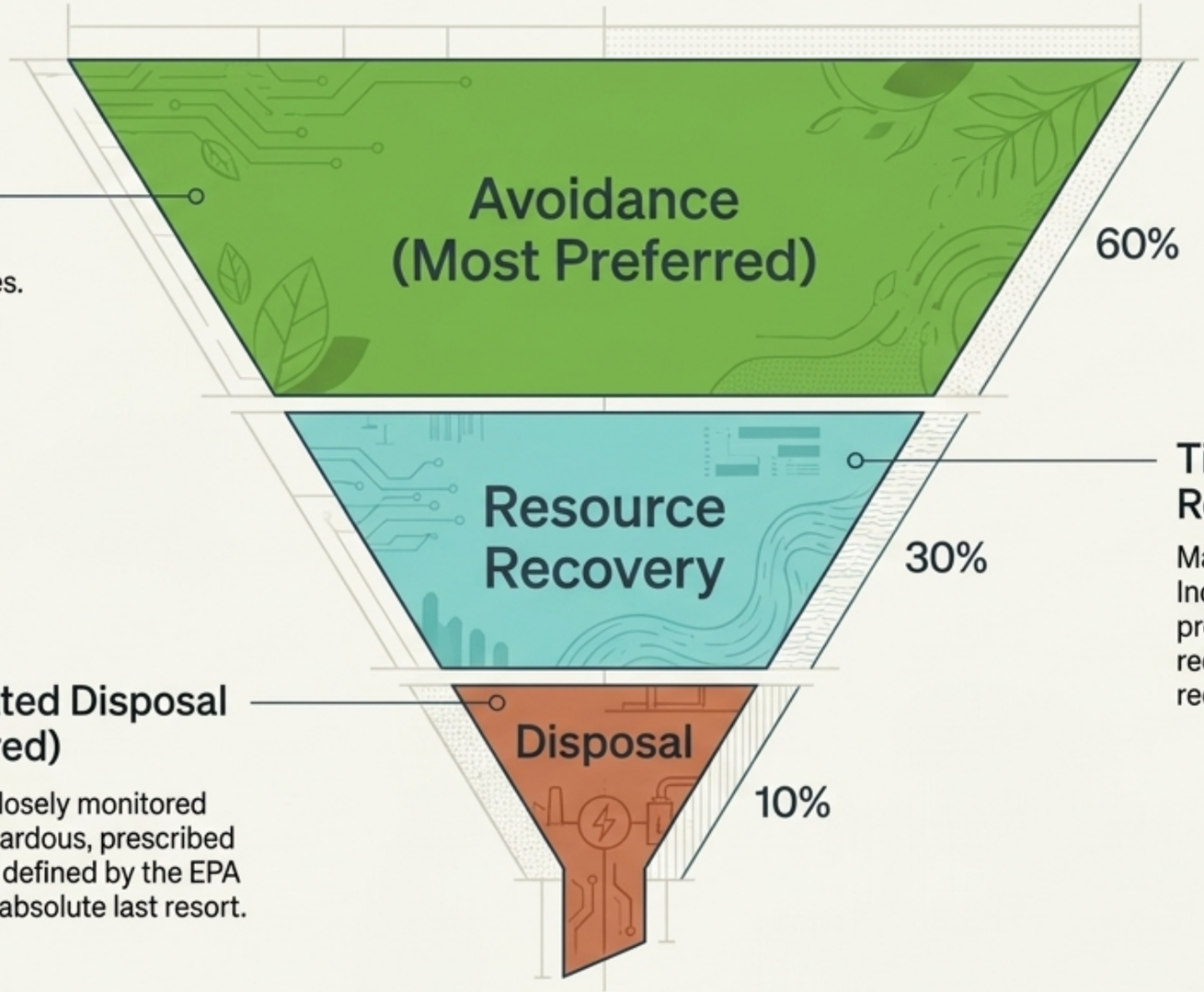
Strategic Sourcing is actively transitioning the campus fleet to zero-emission vehicles, offsetting unavoidable business travel, and influencing partner carshare providers.

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The waste hierarchy: Designing out disposal

Tier 1: Avoidance

Minimizing unnecessary material inputs before they enter campuses. Identifying and replacing existing processes that rely on single-use products and materials.



Tier 2: Resource Recovery & Reuse

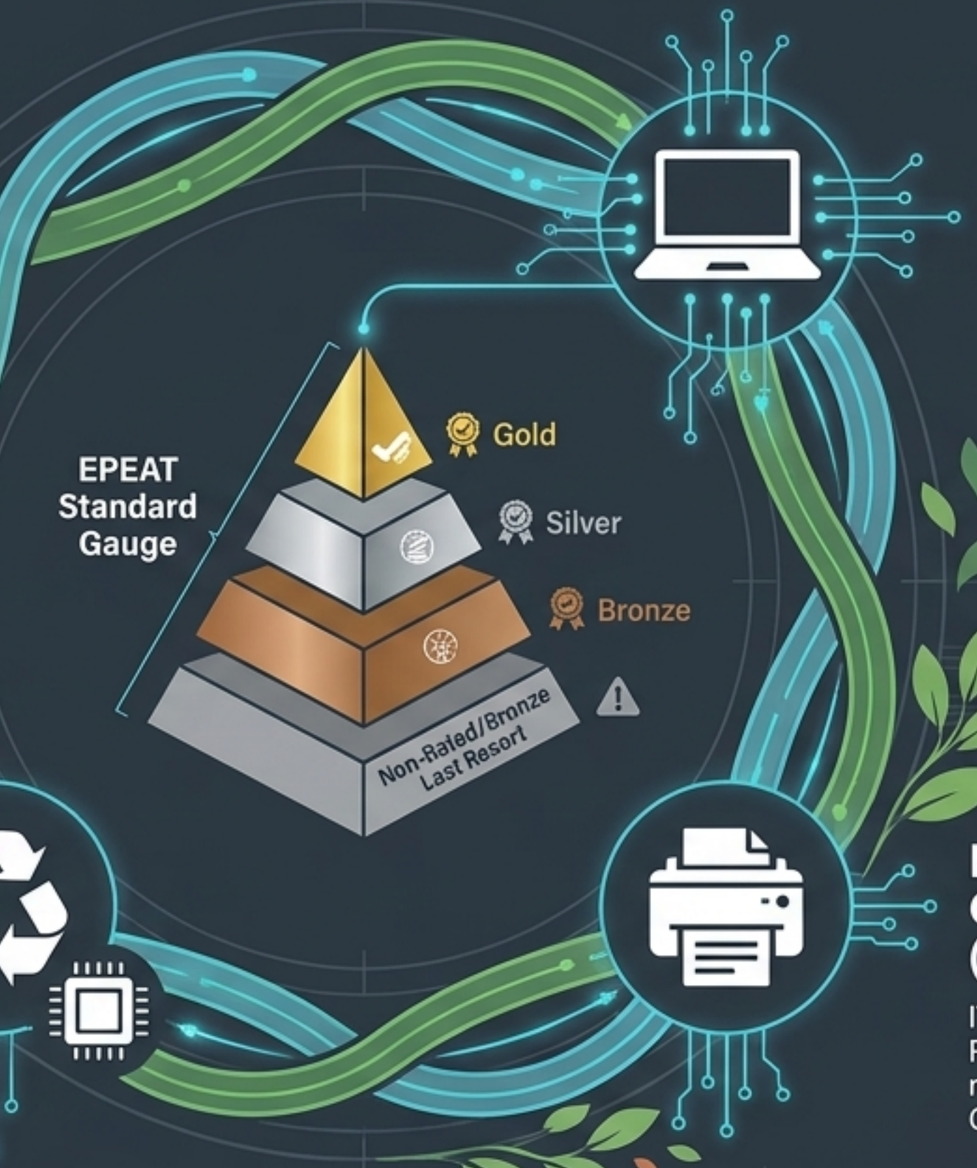
Maintaining circular material flows. Increasing procurement of recycled products, facilitating surplus food redistribution, and maximizing resource recovery during building works.

Tier 3: Regulated Disposal (Least Preferred)

Strictly compliant, closely monitored management of hazardous, prescribed industrial wastes as defined by the EPA 2017. Disposal is an absolute last resort.

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The lifecycle of campus technology



Phase 1: Sustainable Procurement

Information Services mandates Electronic Product Environment Assessment Tool (EPEAT) Gold or Silver hardware. Non-standard equipment requires unavoidable technical justification. Bronze or non-rated equipment is strictly a last resort.

Phase 2: Operational Efficiency (Print Smart)

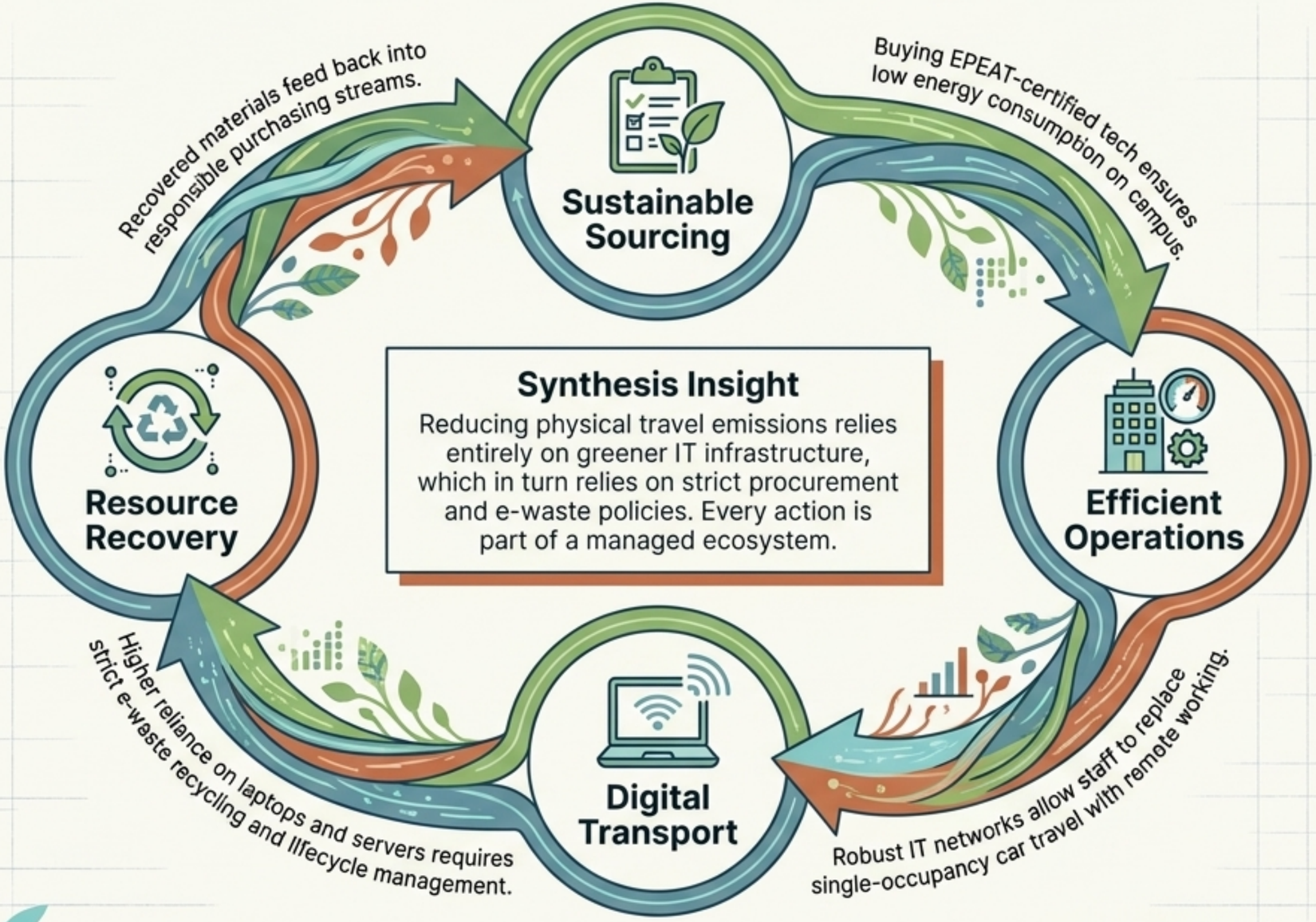
IT actively reduces reliance on paper. Personal printers are restricted—acquisition requires explicit, separate approval from the CIO or their delegate.

Phase 3: Authorized End-of-Life

Hardware is never simply thrown away. Disposal occurs exclusively via return to the leasing company, university resale, or approved e-waste recycling contractors.

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The Circular Campus: How every pillar connects



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Your role in the ecosystem: The daily playbook

Campus Operations

Avoid & Recover

Actively reject single-use materials and maximize resource recovery within your specific work or study environment.

Print Smart

Exclusively utilize centralized multifunction printing devices rather than requesting personal printers.

Be the Eyes of the Campus

Identify and report wasteful practices directly to Infrastructure and Operations at ioservicedesk@latrobe.edu.au.

Academic Integration

Teach the Future

Integrate environmental sustainability principles directly into your curriculum development.

Research with Impact

Develop research initiatives that explore climate change mitigation, biodiversity protection, and sustainable development.

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The horizon: Building the University City of the Future



1

The Ultimate Target

The Sustainability Project Steering Group is relentlessly pursuing absolute Carbon Neutrality across all campuses in the shortest possible time.

2

Continuous Monitoring

Executing the University-Wide Sustainability Plan with strict, annual data collection, measurement, and reporting against our greenhouse gas, water, and waste targets.

3

Next Milestone

Policy Review Date: 14th February 2025.

This is a living blueprint, continually adapting to ensure La Trobe is fully prepared for the future.

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